

# ADAM DOLIN

Narrative Designer · Writer · Creative Consultant

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

17-year game industry veteran specializing in narrative design, writing, and creative consultation. Track record across AAA franchises (God of War, Horizon, Call of Duty), and indie studios (Night School Studio, iam8bit). Experienced in building and leading narrative teams, designing systemic dialog systems, and shipping content from first draft through localization. Active educator and conference speaker.

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## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### iam8bit

October 2025 – Present

#### *Narrative Consultant (Contract) — Petal Runner*

- Evaluated and restructured the game's story; helped refine the narrative pipeline and character arcs.
- Wrote and edited portions of the script.

### SEGA — Internal Studios

March 2024 – Present

#### *Narrative Consultant (Contract)*

- Writing and narrative design support including all cinematics and dialogue for an unannounced title.
- Overseeing a team of junior writers; collaborating with lead producer on scope and delivery.
- Supervising English VO recording sessions for animated content.

### Netflix (Freelance — Netflix Experiences)

September 2024 – Present

#### *Design Consultant (Contract)*

- Freelance design consultant on two upcoming projects, both under NDA.

### Sony PlayStation — Insomniac Games

March 2025 – January 2026

#### *Senior Writer (Contract)*

- Writing and narrative design on an AAA title. Details under NDA.

### Netflix Games — Night School Studio

March 2022 – February 2024

#### *Lead Narrative Designer — Unannounced Title*

- Collaborated with Lead Engineer to design and implement a stylized contextual dialog system in Unity.
- Built and maintained the narrative pipeline: scripts, scratch VO, localization, implementation and revisions.
- Worked with Design Director and Lead Writer to integrate storytelling into our core loop gameplay.

### Sony PlayStation — Santa Monica Studio

May 2015 – February 2022

#### *Senior Writer / Narrative Designer — God of War: Ragnarök*

- Wrote main path and exploration content for Alfheim, Vanaheim, Helheim, and Asgard.
- Ensured design and art aligned with the Narrative Director's vision for the story.

#### *Writer / Narrative Designer — God of War (2018)*

- Wrote all side quests, journal entries, combat banter, and exploration content.
- Designed and implemented an adaptive combat banter system.
- Directed VO sessions for combat banter; coached voice actors for Ancient Norse dialogue.

### Sony PlayStation — Guerrilla Games

#### *Writer — Horizon Forbidden West*

- Wrote quests, exploration content, and in-game features.
- Maintained continuity across lore, narrative outlines, and scripts for cross-department alignment.

### Sony PlayStation — Product Development Services Group

#### *Talent Casting & Dialog Coordinator*

- Coordinated mocap and VO auditions for over a dozen titles, including Days Gone, Spider-Man, God of War, and Death Stranding.
- Booked talent, negotiated rates with agencies, and processed talent paperwork.

### Amazon Games (Freelance)

February – March 2022

#### *Consultant — Two Unannounced Titles (MMORPG & MOBA)*

- Worldbuilding, script writing, and story bible development for new IPs.

## Activision — Sledgehammer Games

April 2014 – May 2015

### Senior Dialog Coordinator — *Call of Duty: Advanced Warfare*

- Maintained script continuity between writers, level designers, and cinematics teams.
- Directed VO sessions, tracked recordings, and coordinated localization asset management.

## 2K Games — Various Studios

September 2011 – April 2014

### Audio Engineer / Consultant

- Dialog Supervisor: XCOM: Enemy Unknown (Firaxis), The Bureau: XCOM Declassified (2K Marin)
- Dialog Editor: The Darkness 2 (Digital Extremes)
- Audio Implementer: Evolve (Turtle Rock Studios)

## Technicolor Interactive

June 2009 – March 2010

### Production Assistant / Editor

- Assisted and edited VO sessions for Mass Effect 2, Uncharted 2, Bulletstorm, Ghost Recon: Future Soldier, and Gears of War 3.

## SPEAKING & TEACHING

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### ELVTR — “Become a Game Writer”

January 2024 – Present

#### Instructor

- Developed and currently teaching a 6-week online course for aspiring game writers and narrative designers (6 cohorts, 100 students per cohort).
- Lectures, workshops, and community moderation via Discord.
- [Student Satisfaction Survey results](#)

**GDC 2026** — Co-presented “[WRITE BETWEEN THE LINES: Writing Games for a Distracted, Polarized, Media-Illiterate World](#)”

**GDC 2026: Amplifying New Voices** — Presentation on public speaking for junior and mid-career developers.

**GDC 2025** — “[STORYTELLING THROUGH SYSTEMS: A Narrative Designer’s Approach](#)”

**GameSoundCon 2024** — “[A Dialogue About Dialog](#)”

## AWARDS & RECOGNITION

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### God of War: Ragnarök

- BAFTA EE Game of the Year (Won) · The Game Awards Best Narrative (Won) · WGA Award (Won) · D.I.C.E. Award (Won)
- Nominated: BAFTA Best Narrative · The Game Awards GOTY

### God of War (2018)

- BAFTA GOTY (Won) · BAFTA Best Narrative (Won) · GDC Award Best Game (Won) · Golden Joystick Best Storytelling (Won)
- Steam Award Outstanding Story-Rich Game (Won) · Nominated: GDC Best Narrative · Nebula Best Interactive Narrative

### Horizon: Forbidden West

- Nominated: BAFTA EE Game of the Year · The Game Awards

## CORE COMPETENCIES

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Narrative Design & Writing  
Screenwriting & Story Architecture  
VO and Mocap Direction & Casting  
Dialogue System Design & Implementation

Localization Pipeline Management  
Team Leadership & Mentorship  
Curriculum Design & Teaching  
UX & Playtesting

## EDUCATION

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Savannah College of Art & Design — BFA - 2009